

OFFICIAL EXPEDITION FIELD STUDY GUIDE & HISTORICAL COMPANION

YPRES 1914–1918

Flanders Fields, Frontline Memory & Local Village Heritage

A comprehensive on-site study companion for pupils and staff. Connecting the Great War memorial tablets of **Holy Rood Church, Stubbington** and **Lee-on-the-Solent** to the preserved trenches, craterfields, and memorial walls of the Ypres Salient.



Tyne Cot Commonwealth War Graves Cemetery · Passchendaele

11,961 Graves · 34,996 Memorial Names

EXPEDITION LEADERSHIP

Mr Ben Lovett (Head of History, Meoncross School)

Mr James Garrett (The History Boys · Battlefield Historian)

Accompanying Staff: Dr Kirkup & Mrs Lushey

EXPEDITION DETAILS

Thursday 1st – Saturday 3rd October 2026

Base: Peace Village Hostel, Heuvelland, Belgium

Coach: Jet Connect Executive Travel

EXPEDITION MASTER ROUTE & TIMETABLE

3-Day Field Expedition · 1st–3rd October 2026

THE YPRES SALIENT
Western Flanders, Belgium

THE SALIENT ROUTE



The Salient Bulge: British lines jutted eastward into German artillery arcs. Defending this ten-mile crescent cost over 500,000 Commonwealth casualties across four brutal years.

HOSTEL BASE & LOGISTICS

Peace Village Hostel

Kemmelbergweg 43, 8956 Heuvelland, Belgium
Rural educational centre at the foot of the Kemmelberg. Secure en-suite group chalets, on-site 2-course dinners, and private recreation grounds.

24/7 EMERGENCY NUMBERS

School Office Base: +44 (0)1329 288339
Trip Leaders Mobile: On 24/7 staff duty throughout tour
Belgian Emergency Services: 112 (European Emergency)

HOURLY FIELD SCHEDULE

DAY & TIME	LOCATION & ACTIVITY	ACADEMIC & CEREMONIAL FOCUS
Day 1 · 06:15	Meoncross Departure	Sharp departure via Jet Connect coach to Folkestone crossing. Packed lunch required.
Day 1 · 14:30	Essex Farm ADS (Stop 1)	Concrete dressing station dugouts; John McCrae's <i>"In Flanders Fields"</i> ; Strudwick grave (age 15).
Day 1 · 15:15	Yorkshire Trench & Langemarck (2&3)	Preserved frontline earthworks followed by dark basalt German Cemetery (24,917 mass grave).
Day 1 · 18:30	Peace Village Hostel Check-in	Room allocation, settle in, 2-course hot group dinner on-site in hostel dining hall.
Day 2 · 09:15	Vancouver Corner & Hooge (4&5)	Brooding Soldier (First Gas Attack, Owen's <i>"Dulce"</i>); Hooge Crater mine warfare & trenches.
Day 2 · 12:45	Supermarket Lunch Stop	Supervised lunch stop (fresh sandwiches & fruit using €30–€40 cash).
Day 2 · 14:15	Tyne Cot Cemetery (Stop 6)	World's largest CWGC cemetery. Search for 4 village fallen on rear curved panels (85, 125, 142).
Day 2 · 18:00	Peace Village Group Dinner	2-course dinner on-site at hostel ahead of evening ceremonial parade in Ypres.
Day 2 · 20:00	The Menin Gate Ceremony (Stop 8)	Solemn Last Post ceremony. Meoncross pupils lay official wreath. Locate Franklin & Ayling (Panel 35).
Day 3 · 09:30	Cloth Hall & Ramparts (Stop 9)	In Flanders Fields Museum; walk the medieval ramparts to the Lille Gate.
Day 3 · 12:45	Talbot House, Poperinge (Stop 10)	Tubby Clayton's 'Everyman's Club' behind the lines; Upper Room hop-loft chapel; piano & tea.
Day 3 · 20:30	Return to Meoncross School	Coach crossing and return to Stubbington for collection by parents.

THE HOME LINK: HOLY ROOD CHURCH MEMORIAL TABLET

Inside **Holy Rood Church, Stubbington**, carved into the marble Great War Memorial Tablet and painted upon the oak tie-beams of the village lychgate, are the names of three brothers from Manor Way Grange, Lee-on-the-Solent: **William, Cyril, and Eric Lowry**. All three gave their lives. On this tour, our pupils carry their memory from Hampshire back to the blood-soaked ground where their youth was spent.



Crofton Tablet

THE THREE LOWRY BROTHERS OF MANOR WAY GRANGE



2nd Lt William Lowry

Second Lieutenant William Lowry (Age 25)

Gallipoli Front

8th Battalion, Duke of Wellington's (West Riding Regiment) • Killed in Action 21 August 1915

The eldest brother. Landing at Suvla Bay during the fierce August Offensive on the Gallipoli Peninsula, he was killed during the assault on Scimitar Hill amidst baking heat and shrapnel fire. His body was never recovered; he is commemorated on the **Helles Memorial** in Turkey.



Capt Cyril Lowry

Captain Cyril John 'Patrick' Lowry (Age 20)

Somme Front

2nd Battalion, West Yorkshire Regiment • Killed in Action 25 March 1918

The youngest brother. Promoted to Captain at just 20. Killed during the catastrophic German Spring Offensive (Operation Michael) near Pozières, leading a desperate counter-attack under the direct command of his older brother Eric, falling mortally wounded in full view of him. Commemorated on the **Pozières Memorial to the Missing**.



Lt Col Eric Lowry

Lieutenant Colonel Auriol Eric Lowry, DSO, MC (Age 25)

Arras & Somme

Commanding 2nd Battalion, West Yorkshire Regiment • Killed in Action 19 September 1918

A decorated frontline hero awarded the Distinguished Service Order and Military Cross for extraordinary bravery under fire. Having witnessed Cyril's death in March, Eric fought on through the Hundred Days Offensive until he was killed leading his battalion near Gouzeaucourt, just six weeks before the Armistice. Buried in **Varennnes Military Cemetery**.

FIELD REFLECTION QUESTION

"How did three sons from one coastal Hampshire home answer the call across Gallipoli, Arras, and the Somme—and what does their mother's loss reveal about the total devastation visited upon families across Britain?"

THE LOCAL HERITAGE MISSION • PART II

Our Six Village Heroes Commemorated on Flanders Memorials

FIELD SEARCH TASK

Tyne Cot & Menin Gate

While three Lowry sons fell on other battlefields, **six young men from Stubbington and Chark** gave their lives in the Ypres Salient and have no known grave. Their names are permanently incised into the stone panels of the Menin Gate and Tyne Cot. Pupils will locate and touch these names on site:

SOLDIER NAME & AGE	REGIMENT & DATE OF DEATH	FLANDERS MEMORIAL PANEL	LOCAL CONNECTION
Private William Franklin Age 27	1st Battalion, Hampshire Regiment 13 May 1915	Menin Gate • Panel 35	Stubbington native. Second Ypres defensive stand.
Private George Ayling Age 28	1st Battalion, Hampshire Regiment 26 April 1915	Menin Gate • Panel 35	Stubbington born; son of George & Mary Ayling.
Private Frederick Muckett Age 21	2nd Battalion, Hampshire Regiment 20 November 1917	Tyne Cot • Panel 85	Born in Chark, Stubbington. Passchendaele offensive.
Private Frank Rye Age 25	1st/4th Bn King's Own Yorkshire L.I. 9 October 1917	Tyne Cot • Panel 125	Resident of Stubbington; Battle of Poelcappelle mud.
Lance Corporal Charles Ward Age 23	8th Battalion, Machine Gun Corps 22 October 1917	Tyne Cot • Panel 142	Stubbington resident; deadly machine gun support.
Private George Warland Age 24	2nd Battalion, Machine Gun Corps 26 October 1917	Tyne Cot • Panel 142	Stubbington native; Second Passchendaele assault.

HOW TO LOCATE OUR FALLEN ON SITE

At the Menin Gate (Friday 8:00 PM): Enter under the central arch. Locate **Panel 35** along the south internal wall for the Hampshire Regiment. Trace your fingers over *Franklin* and *Ayling*.

At Tyne Cot (Friday 14:15): Walk past the Cross of Sacrifice to the rear curved stone walls. Panels are numbered from left to right along the apses. Find **Panel 85** (Hampshires), **Panel 125** (KOYLI), and **Panel 142** (Machine Gun Corps).

TOUR LEADER SCRIPT: ON TOUCHING THE NAMES

"Gather the students by the panel. Ask them to remember the distance from Stubbington Green to this cold Portland stone. Explain that for over a century, their families in Hampshire had no grave to visit, no flowers to leave. When we speak their names aloud today, we break their anonymity and complete a sacred parish promise made in 1919."

Why the Salient Was a Lethal Bulge

A 'salient' is a pocket where frontline positions project into enemy territory. Because the Germans held the surrounding high ground (Passchendaele Ridge, Messines, and Hill 60), every road, trench, and dressing station was visible to enemy forward observers. British troops were pounded by artillery fire from three sides.



"The Menin Road" by Paul Nash (1917): Bottomless Flanders clay churned by millions of high-explosive shells.

The Anatomy of a CWGC Headstone

Created by Sir Fabian Ware and architect Edwin Lutyens, Commonwealth headstones were revolutionary instruments of **total social equality**:



- **Portland Stone:** Identical shape, height, and material for all.
- **No Repatriation:** Wealthy families were forbidden from bringing bodies home.
- **Regimental Badge:** Carved at the top of every stone.
- **Kipling's Epitaph:** "Known unto God" for unidentified men.

TOUR LEADER TALKING POINTS: THE RADICAL EQUALITY OF DEATH

"Before pupils step through the gates of Essex Farm, stop them. Explain that in Victorian Britain, your wealth determined the grandeur of your tomb. Here, Lord and commoner, General and 15-year-old boy like Valentine Strudwick, stand shoulder to shoulder beneath identical slabs of Portland stone. It was Britain's first truly democratic national statement."

KEY FIELD QUESTIONS FOR DAY 1

1. Frontline Triage:

Why did medical dressing stations have to be built directly beneath the canal banks, and how did doctors decide who lived and who died?

2. Architecture & Memory:

Why does Langemarck German Cemetery look so dark and heavy compared to the bright, garden-like Portland stone of British cemeteries?

🔪 STOP 1 TOUR SCRIPT: ESSEX FARM ADS

Where We Stand: Beside the Yser Canal. These concrete bunkers were an Advanced Dressing Station (ADS). Here, Dr John McCrae and his orderlies treated hundreds of shattered soldiers during the Second Battle of Ypres.

What to Notice: Look at the tiny concrete recesses where stretchers were slid in. Notice how low the ceilings are. The doors were hung with sodden blankets to prevent chlorine gas from sinking into the wounds.

Strudwick Grave: Walk to Plot I, Row G, Grave 12: Private Valentine Joe Strudwick, killed in January 1916 aged just **15 years and 11 months**.



Concrete bunkers of the Advanced Dressing Station at Essex Farm

In Flanders Fields

Lieutenant Colonel John McCrae (1872–1918) · Composed at Essex Farm, 3rd May 1915



*In Flanders fields the poppies blow
Between the crosses, row on row,
That mark our place; and in the sky
The larks, still bravely singing, fly
Scarce heard amid the guns below.*

*We are the Dead. Short days ago
We lived, felt dawn, saw sunset glow,
Loved and were loved, and now we lie,
In Flanders fields.*

*Take up our quarrel with the foe:
To you from failing hands we throw
The torch; be yours to hold it high.
If ye break faith with us who die
We shall not sleep, though poppies grow
In Flanders fields.*

Historical Note: Written on the step of an ambulance the morning after McCrae buried his close friend Lt Alexis Helmer. It became the global inspiration for the Remembrance Poppy.

🔪 STOP 2 TOUR SCRIPT: YORKSHIRE TRENCH & DUGOUT

The Rediscovery: Uncovered in 1998 by amateur archaeologists in an industrial estate, this trench was restored on its exact 1915 footprint.

What to Notice: Look down at the wooden A-frame duckboards. Notice the sump channels beneath them. Because the water table here is only two feet below ground, trenches filled with freezing water within minutes. Soldiers stood for days in wet boots, causing agonizing 'trench foot' that could lead to gangrene and amputation.

🔪 STOP 3 TOUR SCRIPT: THE CONTRAST OF LANGEMARCK

The German Experience: Over 44,000 German soldiers lie in Langemarck. Under the Treaty of Versailles, Germany was not permitted to use gleaming white stone or individual Christian crosses.

The Kameradengrab (Comrades' Grave): Right inside the entrance gate lies a single mass grave containing **24,917 German soldiers**. Around it stand bronze panels engraved with their names.

Emil Krieger's Statues: At the rear of the cemetery stand four dark bronze figures of mourning soldiers, gazing toward their fallen comrades.

To Germany

Captain Charles Hamilton Sorley (1895–1915) • 7th Bn Suffolk Regt • Killed at Loos, aged 20



*You are blind like us. Your hurt no man designed,
And no man claimed the conquest of your land.
But both have gone warring against the dark; and so we stand
Looking beyond each other in the blind night,
And only reach each other through the night
Of our own darkness, like men in a cave.
You are only our brothers who have made
The same mistake; and when the fight is done,
We shall cross the fields of blood and tears,
And take each other's hands, and be at peace.*

Historical Note: Sorley lived and studied in Germany before the war and rejected anti-German hatred. Found in his kit-bag after his death.

⚠️ HISTORICAL INSIGHT: THE 'LANGEMARCK-MYTHOS' (STUDENT MYTH)

In October 1914, raw German student volunteers were slaughtered by British rifle fire at First Ypres. The German High Command issued a false dispatch claiming the students advanced singing "*Deutschland über alles*". Later in the 1930s, Adolf Hitler visited Langemarck and used this myth to indoctrinate Hitler Youth into blind sacrifice. Remind students that history is often twisted for political propaganda.

STOP 4 TOUR SCRIPT: VANCOUVER CORNER (ST JULIEN)

22nd April 1915: The First Lethal Gas Attack in world history. German forces opened 5,730 cylinders of liquid chlorine gas. A dense greenish-yellow cloud rolled southwest across French colonial troops, who suffocated or fled in panic.

The Canadian Stand: Canadian soldiers held the ruptured line using urine-soaked cloths to neutralize the gas. Look up at *The Brooding Soldier*: his hands rest upon the reversed butt of his rifle in silent, eternal mourning.



Dulce et Decorum Est

Wilfred Owen, MC (1893–1918) • Composed 1917

*Gas! GAS! Quick, boys!—An ecstasy of fumbling,
Fitting the clumsy helmets just in time;
But someone still was yelling out and stumbling,
And flound'ring like a man in fire or lime...
Dim, through the misty panes and thick green light,
As under a green sea, I saw him drowning.*

*In all my dreams, before my helpless sight,
He plunges at me, guttering, choking, drowning...*

STOP 5: HOOGE CRATER & SANCTUARY WOOD (HILL 62)



The 1915 mine crater blown by 3rd Canadian Tunnelling Co.



Preserved sandbagged frontline trenches at Sanctuary Wood

STOP 5 TOUR SCRIPT: UNDERGROUND WARFARE & MUD

The War Beneath the Ground: At Hooze, British and German trenches were less than 15 yards apart. Unable to cross No Man's Land above ground, miners dug tunnels deep into the clay, planting tons of ammonal explosive beneath enemy listening posts.

Walk the Preserved Mud: As you walk the corrugated iron revetments, imagine living in this quagmire for days with constant shell-splinters, buzzing flies, and the smell of stagnant water and decaying horses.

🔪 STOP 6 TOUR SCRIPT: THE SCALE OF PASSCHENDAELE

The Staggering Figures: 11,961 soldiers are buried here. Of these, **8,369 are unidentified**—their headstones bear only Kipling's words: "*A Soldier of the Great War • Known unto God*".

The Pillboxes of Passchendaele: In October 1917, this was a heavily defended German bunker stronghold. King George V suggested that the Great Cross of Sacrifice be built directly atop the central captured German pillbox.

The Missing: On the curved memorial walls at the rear are carved the names of **34,996 officers and men** who fell after 16 August 1917 and have no known resting place.



The Cross of Sacrifice erected directly over a German concrete bunker

🔍 LOCATING OUR FOUR VILLAGE FALLEN ON TYNE COT WALLS

Pupils must disperse along the rear curved colonnade to find and touch four heroes of Stubbington:

- **Panel 85: Private Frederick Muckett** (2nd Hampshire Regt, born in Chark, fell 20 Nov 1917, age 21)
- **Panel 125: Private Frank Rye** (1st/4th King's Own Yorkshire Light Infantry, fell 9 Oct 1917, age 25)
- **Panel 142: Lance Corporal Charles Ward** (8th Machine Gun Corps, fell 22 Oct 1917, age 23)
- **Panel 142: Private George Warland** (2nd Machine Gun Corps, fell 26 Oct 1917, age 24)

Anthem for Doomed Youth

Wilfred Owen, MC (1893–1918) • Composed at Craiglockhart Hospital, 1917



*What passing-bells for these who die as cattle?
— Only the monstrous anger of the guns.
Only the stuttering rifles' rapid rattle
Can patter out their hasty orisons.
No mockeries now for them; no prayers nor bells;
Nor any voice of mourning, save the choirs,—
The shrill, demented choirs of wailing shells;
And bugles calling for them from sad shires.*

STOP 8 TOUR SCRIPT: THE MENIN GATE

The Gateway to the Front: Through this eastern rampart opening marched hundreds of thousands of British and Commonwealth troops on their way to the frontline. For tens of thousands, it was their final march.

54,395 Names of the Missing: Designed by Sir Reginald Blomfield. Engraved with the names of soldiers who fell in the Salient before 16 August 1917 with no known grave.

The Last Post Tradition: Every evening at **8:00 PM sharp** since 1928, the Ypres volunteer fire brigade sound bugles beneath the arch. Traffic stops, and silence falls.



The Menin Gate Memorial to the Missing, Ypres

MEONCROSS SCHOOL WREATH-LAYING PROTOCOL

Selected Meoncross School pupils will step forward beneath the central arch to lay an official commemorative wreath on behalf of the school and the community of Stubbington. All students must stand in smart, dignified silence, coats buttoned, hats off, listening to the Buglers of the Last Post Association.

For the Fallen (The Ode of Remembrance)

Laurence Binyon (1869–1943) • Written September 1914 on the cliffs of Cornwall



*They shall grow not old, as we that are left grow old:
Age shall not weary them, nor the years condemn.
At the going down of the sun and in the morning
We will remember them.*

(All assemble and respond together: "We will remember them.")

Panel 35 Task: Before the crowd gathers, pupils will locate **Private Franklin** and **Private Ayling** on Panel 35 (Hampshire Regiment).

DAY 3 FIELD STOPS • REBIRTH & FELLOWSHIP

Stops 9 & 10 • Ypres Cloth Hall & Talbot House (Everyman's Club)

POPERINGE & YPRES
Saturday Morning

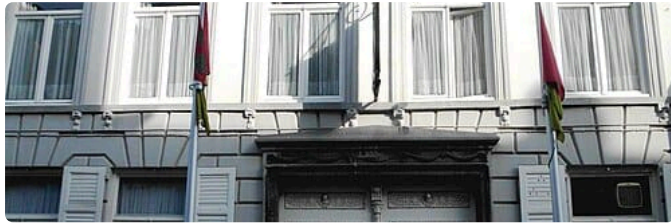
📍 STOP 9 TOUR SCRIPT: THE REBIRTH OF YPRES

Total Destruction: By 1918, Ypres was rubble; Winston Churchill wanted the ruins left as a sacred memorial. Instead, citizens rebuilt stone-for-stone.

The Lakenhalle (Cloth Hall): Built in 1304 as Europe's greatest commercial market. Completely demolished by shellfire in 1914–1918. Rebuilt over 40 years. Inside is the *In Flanders Fields Museum*.



The Cloth Hall in total ruins, 1919 (top) & rebuilt today



Soldiers relaxing inside Tubby Clayton's 'Everyman's Club', 1916

📍 STOP 10 TOUR SCRIPT: TALBOT HOUSE (TOC H)

The Haven Behind the Lines: In December 1915, Army Chaplain Rev. Philip 'Tubby' Clayton opened this house in Poperinge as an alternative to pubs and brothels.

"Abandon all rank that enter here": Officers and privates drank tea from the same mugs, played the same piano, and slept in the same garden.

The Upper Room: Climb the creaking wooden stairs to the hop-loft chapel. The carpenter's bench altar provided solace to soldiers hours before they returned to the Salient mud.

The Soldier

Rupert Brooke (1887–1915) • Sub-Lieutenant, Royal Naval Division

*If I should die, think only this of me:
That there's some corner of a foreign field
That is for ever England. There shall be
In that rich earth a richer dust concealed;
A dust whom England bore, shaped, made aware,
Gave, once, her flowers to love, her ways to roam;
A body of England's, breathing English air,
Washed by the rivers, blest by suns of home.*



Trench & Military Terminology

ADS	Advanced Dressing Station: Frontline medical bunker behind trenches for urgent triage before casualty evacuation.
A-Frames	A-shaped timber frames supporting duckboard walkways above waterlogged trench mud.
Pillbox	Reinforced concrete machine gun bunker built by German forces to withstand heavy artillery shellfire.
Salient	A bulge in military lines surrounded by the enemy on three sides, exposed to converging artillery arcs.
Sump	A deep drainage pit dug beneath trench duckboards to catch pooling rainwater.
Trench Foot	Severe medical condition caused by prolonged immersion in cold, wet mud, causing gangrene.

CWGC & Memorial Terminology

CWGC	Commonwealth War Graves Commission: Founded 1917 by Fabian Ware to care for 1.7 million fallen.
Cross of Sacrifice	Designed by Sir Reginald Blomfield: Portland stone cross bearing a bronze broadsword.
Stone of Memory	Designed by Sir Edwin Lutyens: altar-like stone carved with Kipling's phrase <i>"Their Name Liveth For Evermore"</i> .
Kameradengrab	German 'Comrades' Grave': a central mass burial holding thousands of fallen soldiers (e.g. 24,917 at Langemarck).
Portland Stone	Fine white limestone from Dorset, chosen for its luminosity and radical equality.

BE USEFUL FLEMISH & FRENCH TOPONYMS IN THE SALIENT

- Ieper:** Flemish name for Ypres.
- Poperinge:** Town behind lines known affectionately to British troops as *"Pop"*.
- Heuvelland:** 'Hill Country' south of Ypres (home of our Peace Village Hostel base).
- Lakenhalle:** The medieval Cloth Hall in the Grote Markt of Ypres.
- Menenpoort:** Flemish for the Menin Gate.

CODE OF CONDUCT & EXPEDITION STANDARDS

- Quiet Respect:** Cemeteries are active places of mourning. Walk strictly on grass paths; do not sit on headstones or climb on memorial panels.
- Mobile Phone Protocol:** Phones may be used for photographs during the day. Collected each evening in dedicated staff bags at curfew.
- Hostel Downtime:** Quiet hours from 22:00 in Peace Village corridors. Respect international guests and staff sleep cycles.
- The Mission:** Always remember that we represent Meoncross School and our village parish of Holy Rood before the people of Belgium.

Expedition Staff: Mr Ben Lovett & Mr James Garrett (Tour Leaders) · Dr Kirkup & Mrs Lushey (Accompanying Staff) School Base 24/7 Emergency: **+44 (0)1329 288339**